

**Bedtime Tales**

# Dusty the Donkey's Long Ears

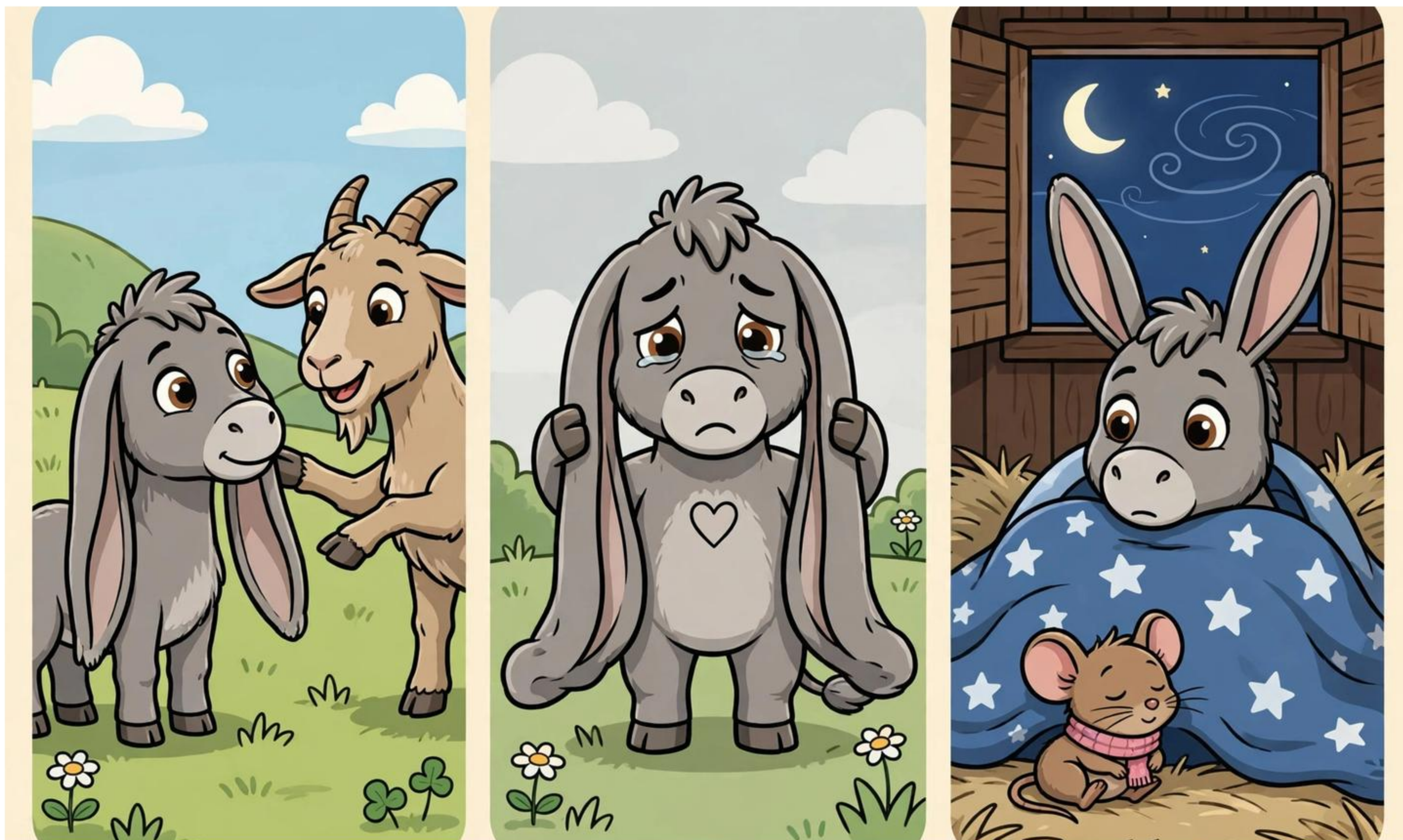


**KIDS BOOK VIDEOS**

Dusty was a small gray donkey who lived on a sunny hillside farm. He had very long ears — longer than any donkey around. They flopped when he walked (flop flop) and bounced when he trotted (bounce bounce).

The other animals teased him gently. "Watch out for those ears!" laughed the goat. Dusty tried to hold his ears still, but they flopped anyway, and his heart sank. "I wish my ears were short," he sighed.

One windy night, Dusty could not sleep. The wind howled through the hills — Whoooo! — and it sounded scary, so he hid under his blanket with his long ears poking out. Then he heard something else, very faint and very sweet. It was his friend Basil the barn mouse, singing a lullaby far away — too far for short ears to hear. But Dusty's long ears caught every word. La la, sleep now, la la. His long ears were like super ears!



The next morning, Dusty told Basil. "Your long ears heard my song?" squeaked Basil. "Every word," said Dusty proudly.

Basil smiled. "Then remember this," she said. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs."

"Long ears hear the sweetest songs." Dusty repeated it happily. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs." It became his proud saying. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs."



That evening, Basil sang again, and Dusty listened with his long ears. La la, sleep now, la la. He heard the crickets too, and the owl's soft hoot, and the breeze in the grass — so many sweet songs! He did not wish for short ears anymore. Flop flop, bounce bounce — they were perfect.

Can you listen like Dusty? Cup your hands behind your ears. Now listen for the sweetest sound. What do you hear?



Dusty shared his gift. He told the goat about the owl's song and the chickens about the cricket choir, and soon everyone wanted long-ears listening lessons. "Cup your ears and listen," he taught them, and the whole farm became a listening farm.

That night, Dusty curled in his straw while Basil sang her lullaby. La la, sleep now, la la. His long ears caught every note. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs," he yawned. The wind was gentle now, the stars twinkled softly, and Dusty slept, listening to sweet dreams.



The very thing that makes you  
different might be your greatest  
gift of all.

**The End**

